



Page 1 of 4 · The Stones Turn Sideways

Hop-Tart reaches the pond as the first raindrops dimple the water. A fast current has spun every stepping stone sideways. Hop could leap across alone, but Centi-Peed needs a path with small, even gaps. Together they find three rows with four safe stones in each.



Page 2 of 4 · Reeds for Every Rail

The stones are steady, but Centi-Peed’s many little feet need handrails. Flutter-Butter brings 24 strong reed ties. The friends share them equally across six short bridge sections, checking that no section is wobblier than another.



Page 3 of 4 · The Three Spare Glow-Seeds

Centi-Peed counts 19 glow-seeds for marking the route. Four seeds fit neatly around each landing stone. After four complete groups, three seeds remain. Hop-Tart starts to call them leftovers, then notices the darkest bend in the path.



Page 4 of 4 · A Path That Waits

The three spare seeds light the difficult bend, and two final groups of eight markers glow along the bank. Hop-Tart slows his biggest bounce to match Centi-Peed’s careful steps. They reach shelter together—not by making the fastest path, but by making one that waits for everyone.

Questions for Hop-Tart and the Stepping-Stone Switch

Read the story together first. Use one question at each page, then the question at the end. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · The Stones Turn Sideways

How many safe stones are in 3 rows of 4?

Choices: 7 · 10 · 12 · 16

Page 2 · Reeds for Every Rail

How many reed ties belong on each of the 6 sections?

Choices: 3 · 4 · 6 · 8

Page 3 · The Three Spare Glow-Seeds

How many complete groups of 4 can they make from 19 seeds?

Choices: 3 · 4 · 5 · 7

Page 4 · A Path That Waits

How many markers are in 2 groups of 8?

Choices: 10 · 14 · 16 · 18

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 12. Three equal rows of 4 make 4 + 4 + 4 = 12, so 3 x 4 = 12.

Page 2: 4. Share 24 into 6 equal groups. Since 6 x 4 = 24, each section gets 4 ties.

Page 3: 4. Four groups use 4 x 4 = 16 seeds. Three remain, so 19 ÷ 4 makes 4 complete groups with remainder 3.

Page 4: 16. Double 8 to find two equal groups: 8 + 8 = 16.

Free to read online and print: snackpackuniverse.com/read